

Reflective Report

This coursework provided an opportunity to create a complete web page based on textual and visual specifications, utilizing only semantic HTML and custom CSS. In the process, I was able to better understand the way structure and presentation work separately, as well as how contemporary web development tools can enhance efficiency and consistency.

The creation of the HTML was not very hard, as the structure of the page was well represented in the chessboxing.txt file that was provided and the reference layout. Semantic elements include `<header>`, `<main>`, `<nav>`, `article`, `figure`, `section` and `footer` which helped to structure the document logically. The issue of accessibility needed to be addressed, in particular, the use of descriptive alt text on all images and such features as a skip link when using the keyboard. But HTML was mostly acting as desired; the design appeared fair without CSS, which allowed the structural foundation to be right (Laakso, 2025). Also, testing the HTML through the W3C validator motivated better markup and better knowledge of the contemporary standards (Ara et al., 2024).

On the other hand, it was more difficult to write the CSS. It was necessary to employ the tools of responsive design to recreate the look in the large and small screenshots. It took several attempts in order to get a centred block of content, line control, and maintainability of the layout at a minimum width of 200px. The hardest part consisted of ensuring that the background of the header would always stay visible, no matter how small the window is, and the responding navigation bar. Other special treatment was needed with floated elements as well, where the ability to wrap text to a large screen and prohibit floats on small ones. CSS is not always cross-browser, and it was necessary to test it in Chrome and Firefox. In spite of the fact that I felt more at ease with CSS during the assignment, it was obvious that style does not come as easily as HTML.

Current frameworks, like Bootstrap or Tailwind CSS, would have been much faster in development. The grid system, responsive utilities, and ready-made navigation elements of Bootstrap would make the layout building much easier without requiring any custom media queries (Cheng, 2024). The utility classes of Tailwind would help to eliminate repetition in the spacing, colours, and typography. The two frameworks are also much stronger in terms of dealing with accessibility issues. Nevertheless, the limitation of pure CSS in this coursework promoted the comprehension of the background principles, which will be beneficial in the long-term development of the skills.

The solution may also be enhanced by other contemporary web technologies. CSS grid would allow layout alignment to be more flexible, and floats would no longer be needed, whereas flexbox would make it easier to center vertically and horizontally. Other improvements may be introduced to make it easier to use, like animation, fewer motion preferences, or ARIA roles. Since responsive design and accessibility are still defining the current trends in web standards, it is important that these key techniques are mastered.

On the whole, the work on this project reinforced my knowledge of the structure of webpages, their accessibility, and responsive styling. Although it was possible to automate a lot of tasks using modern frameworks, this assignment helped to appreciate the importance of learning basic HTML and CSS before using more advanced tools.

Reference

Ara, J., Sik-Lanyi, C., Kelemen, A. and Tibor Guzsvinecz (2024). An inclusive framework for automated web content accessibility evaluation. *Universal Access in the Information Society*. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10209-024-01164-5> .

Cheng, D. (2024). Research on HTML5 Responsive Web Front-end Development Based on Bootstrap Framework. pp.711–718. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1109/cisat62382.2024.10695228> .

Laakso, J. (2025). *Comparison of the standardization processes of ECMAScript, HTML, and CSS*. [online] Aalto.fi. Available at: <https://aaltodoc.aalto.fi/items/804e3500-b4ae-4673-b98e-ce7992461772> .